



FOOTBALL
QUEENSLAND



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FOUNDATION OF FOOTBALL MODEL SESSIONS



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OVERVIEW



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Thank you for enrolling in our **Foundation of Football Course!**

After the course you will be equipped with the tools you need to create a fun, safe and inclusive football experience for your young players. To help you get started, we've included some example session plans.

Remember, these sessions are just a starting point!

Feel free to adapt them using **SOCHANGEIT** to suit your team's specific needs.

Yours in football!

FQ Coach Education Team

S	SAFE Physically free from hazards and danger. Emotionally safe and supportive environment.
O	OBSERVE Is everything set up as you would like? Does it look like football? Is everyone engaged?
C	COACHING STYLES How do you speak to the players? Too much/too little talk? Positive engagement.
H	HOW TO SCORE Do they know how to score/get points? Goals involved, number of passes, end zones.
A	AREA Does the area size suit the players/activity/game? Increase or decrease accordingly.
N	NUMBERS Even or uneven? Do the teams need changing to maximise participation?
G	GAME RULES Change rules to engage everyone. Only tackle from in front, if Sarah scores = 3 goals.
E	EQUIPMENT Different coloured cones and bibs. Lots of footballs, more goals, bigger/smaller goals.
I	INCLUSION Everyone involved and engaged. Give every player a little bit of your time.
T	TIME Reduce or extend time to increase motivation and enjoyment. Add time limits to score.

SPECIFIC ASPECTS



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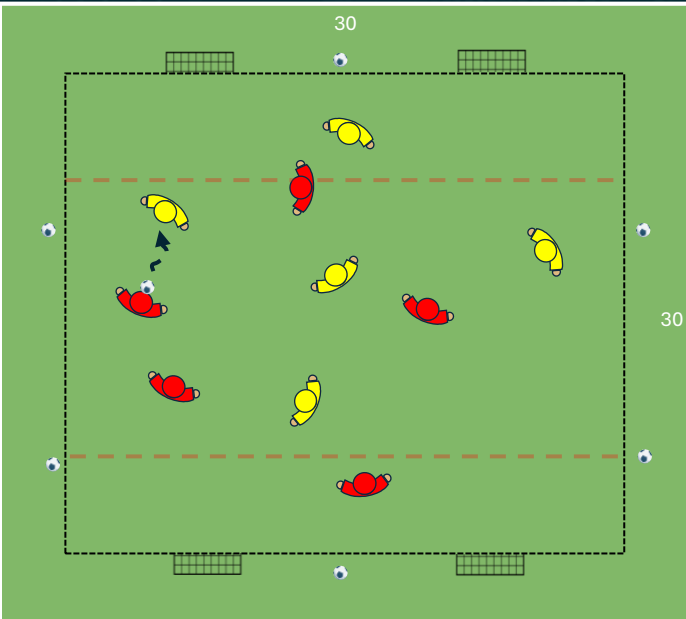
Below are some of the Technical Skills and Specific Aspects you may wish to consider when designing sessions.

TECHNICAL SKILL	DRIBBLING	1v1s	PASSING	RECEIVING	FINISHING
SPECIFIC ASPECTS	• Dribbling forward into space • Dribbling to change direction • Dribbling into the penalty box to score • Dribbling with a defender at your side (screening) • Dribbling turning out • Dribbling towards a teammate to do a takeover / underlap / overlap • Dribbling to attack space from deep to create 2v1 opportunities	• 1v1 change of direction • 1v1 attacking with defender marking from behind • 1v1 attacking with defender in front • 1v1 attacking from a static situation (attacker, defender and ball all still) • 1v1 attacking against the GK • 1v1 with creativity • 1v1 shielding the ball • 1v1 defending to stop forward pass / movement / recovery runs • 1v1 to defend a shot at goal • 1v1 defending in a 1v2 situation	• Passing forward to break lines • 1-2 pass to beat a defender • Through ball / Killer Pass • Chipping the ball (lofted pass) • Crossing • Cut-backs • Volley / half-volley	• Receiving with first touch forward / into space • Receiving between the lines • Receiving away from the opponent / out of tackling range • Receiving weight and direction to control possession • Receiving tightly marked from behind • Receiving - close aerial control • Receiving - No touch turn (deception/dummy)	• Finishing with placement • Finishing with power • Finishing first time • Finishing with acrobatic volley / half-volley / bicycle kick • Finishing with a header

PLAY-PRACTICE-PLAY



The Play-Practice-Play (P-P-P) approach is a player-centered training format that allows players to learn through gameplay, practice, and reflection. P-P-P gives our players more of what they enjoy (gameplay), paints clear pictures and allows for coaches to check for transfer of learning in the Play (observe) phase.

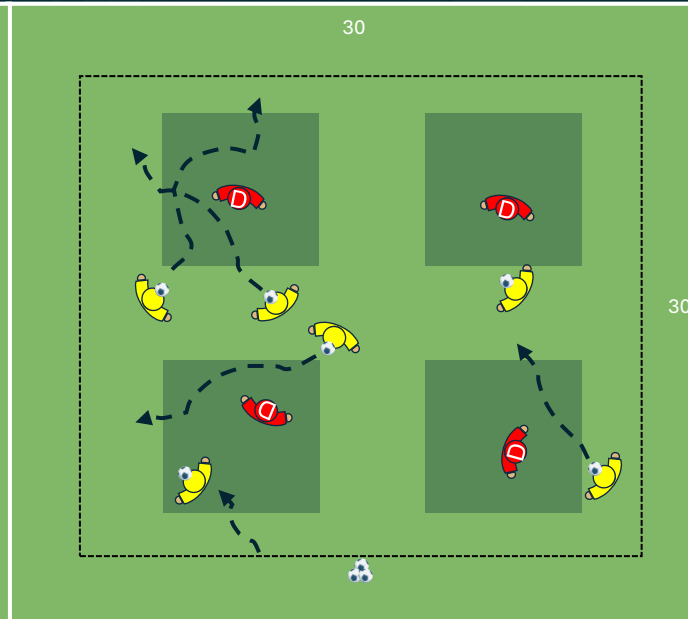


PLAY

Role of the Coach: **Influence**

The coach's role in the play phase is to **influence** the theme of today's sessions with subtle session design and concise and clear coaching interventions.

In your interventions, introduce the theme! Ensure you manage the shape and behaviours of both teams first to bring your topic to life.

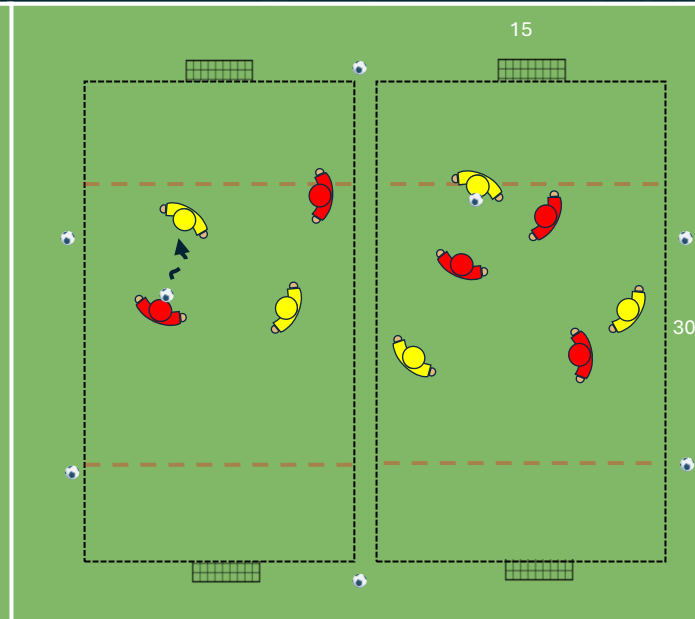


PRACTICE

Role of the Coach: **Teach**

The coach's role in the practice phase is to **teach!** Break down the technique and decision making within the specific aspect and allow the players the freedom to practice.

Depending on your session length, you may wish to have 1 or 2 practices.



PLAY

Role of the Coach: **Observe**

The coach's role in the final play phase is to **observe** and check if learning has taken place.

Coaches should positively reinforce the players when they see attempts to work towards the session theme.

DRIBBLING



Specific Aspect: Dribbling to attack space from deep to create 2v1 opportunities.

Play - influence

- 2v2+1 small sided games.
- The blue playmaker ('P') plays for the team in possession.
- When ball goes out, the ball is to be dribbled back into the area (to encourage more dribbling outcomes).
- If you can complete a 1-2 before scoring = 2 goals.
- If you can dribble over the half-way line before scoring = 2 goals.
- Any other type of scoring = 1 goal.
- Play as a tournament, each team accumulates points across games.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today we are working on improving our dribbling and our decision making in a 2v1, when to dribble or when to pass!"
- Technique of dribbling (positive touch, drive towards defenders' front foot etc).
- Deceiving the defender with a fake pass or by committing them.
- Players identifying when to run with the ball versus when to pass.
- The player off the ball relocating when the defender has effectively cut them off from the ball carrier.

Practice - Teach

- On both grids, start the practice with 1x defender ('D') and 1x attacker ('A') in the area.
- On both grids, one player drives in to create a 2v1 against the defender who only defends passively to start.
- Yellow players work together to score in the opposite mini goal.
- Once the ball is dead, the yellow player who drove in, dribbles over to the other grid. Repeat once A & D get back to position.
- Rotate A & D every two minutes.

Possible Progressions:

- Defenders can now intercept and try to score.

Coaching Points:

- Technique of dribbling (positive touch, drive towards defenders' front foot etc).
- Deceiving the defender with a fake pass or by committing them.
- Players identifying when to run with the ball versus when to pass.
- The player off the ball relocating when the defender has effectively cut them off from the ball carrier.

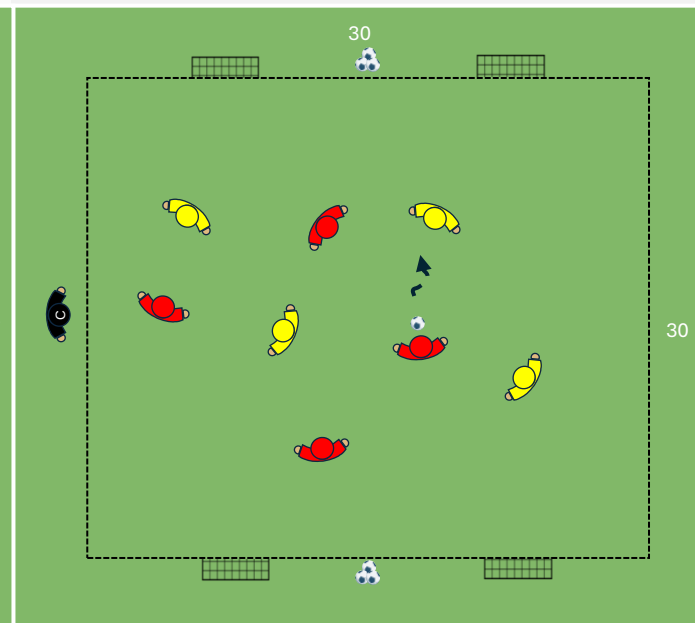
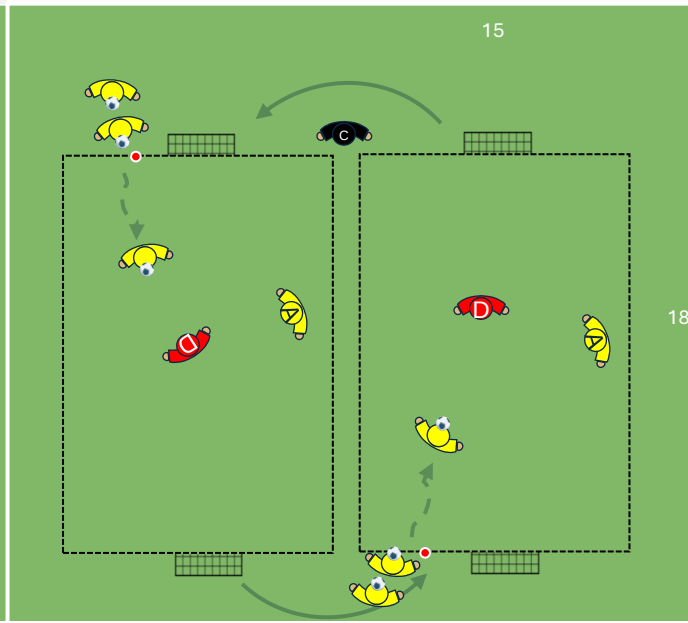
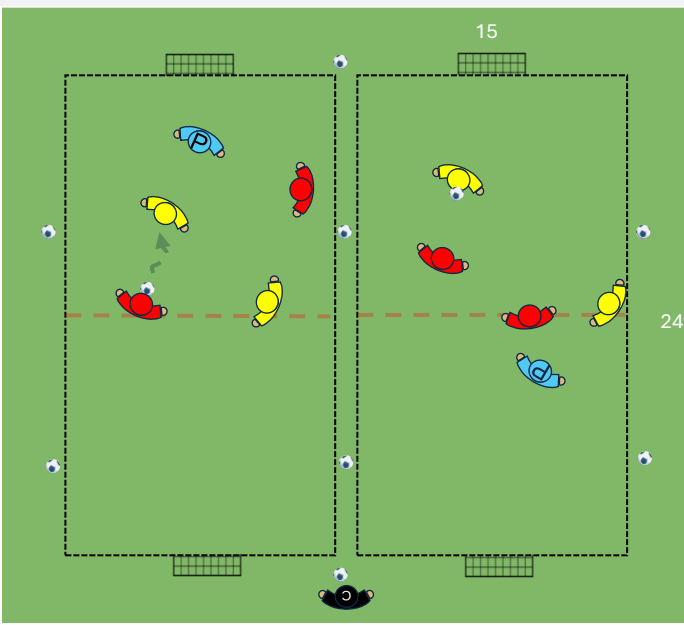
Play - Observe

- 5v5 4 goal game.
- If you can complete a 1-2 before scoring = 3 goals.
- Every other goal worth 1.

Encourage 2v1s and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



DRIBBLING



Specific Aspect: Dribbling forward into space.

Play - Influence

- 5v5 small sided 4 goal game.
- When ball goes out, ball is to be dribbled back into the area (to encourage more dribbling).
- If you can dribble over the oppositions final third line before scoring = 3 goals.
- Any other goal is worth 1.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today we are working on dribbling into space, when you see space in front, can you drive forward with the ball!?"
- Smaller touches in tight spaces, bigger touches and acceleration in open space.
- Technique of dribbling (both feet, point foot down, inside/out of laces),
- Deception in approach to create more space between you and the defender (can you drop your shoulder one way and then go the other?).
- Scanning – Check for Space, Time, Opponents.

Practice - Teach

- 4 players start as defenders within 4mx4m boxes,
- The rest of the players have a ball each,
- Players have 1 minute to dribble in and out of as many squares as they can (keep score!).
- Defenders start semi opposed, only jockeying for the first two rounds (allowing players to practice their dribbling).

Possible Progressions:

- Bigger/Smaller Squares.
- Defenders are fully opposed – if they win the ball your score resets.
- If the defender wins the ball, they dribble, you take their place.

Coaching Points:

- Smaller touches in tight spaces, bigger touches and acceleration in open space.
- Technique of dribbling (both feet, point foot down, inside/out of laces),
- Deception in approach to create more space between you and the defender (can you drop your shoulder one way and then go the other?).
- Scanning – Check for Space, Time, Opponents.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,
- Game can be played as a tournament (players accumulate points each game).

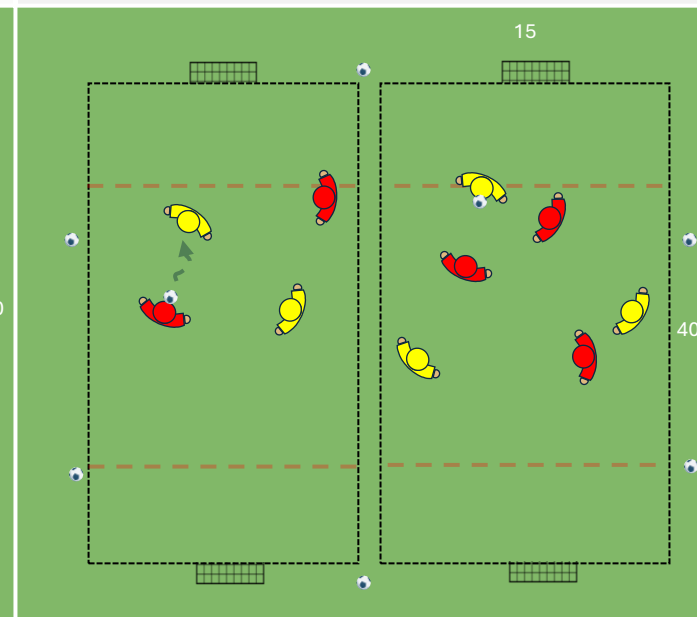
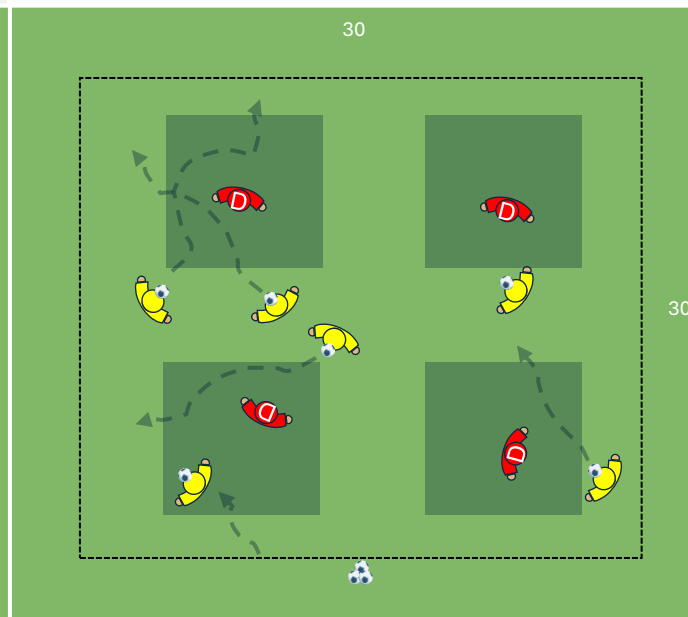
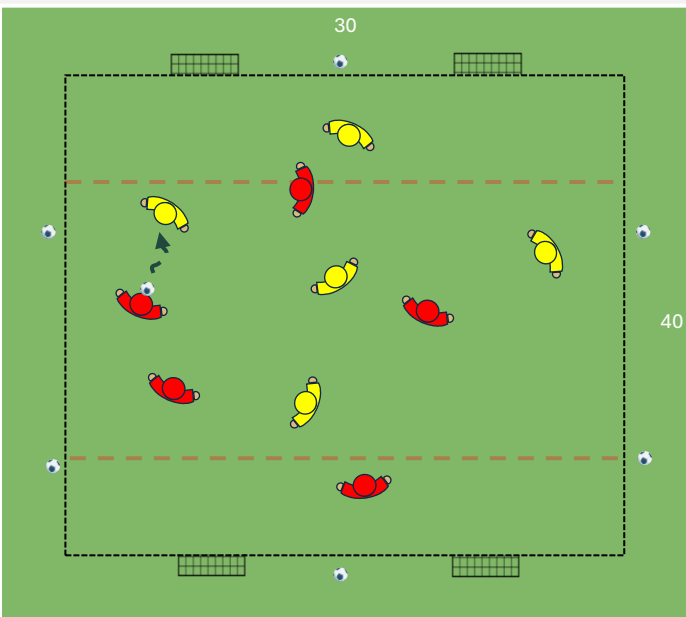
Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can dribble over the opponents final third line before scoring = 3 goals.
- Every other goal worth 1.

Encourage dribbling and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



Specific Aspect: 1v1 attacking with defender in front.

Play – Influence

- 2v2/3v3 small sided games.
- When ball goes out, ball is to be dribbled back into the area (to encourage more 1v1s).
- If you can beat a player with skill and then score = 3 goals.
- Any other goal is worth 1.
- Play as a tournament, each team accumulates points across games.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today's session is all about beating players 1v1, Be creative and take players on!"
- First touch forward and attack quickly,
- Drive towards the defenders front foot,
- Distance for skill move (not too far, not too close),
- Opportunity to break down skill moves that work well against a defender in front (scissor, sole roll etc.).
- Disguise using your body (arms, eyes, shoulders) to disguise your move,
- Creativity – try different moves and see what works.
- Accelerate away after player is beaten.

Practice - Teach

- Yellow drives forward to begin practice,
- Practice starts semi opposed with red defender jockeying the ball until yellow skills past and scores.
- Once ball is dead, players switch roles and resting players go.

Possible Progressions:

- Develop practice to fully opposed.
- Additional points for using skill moves and then scoring.

Coaching Points:

- First touch forward and attack quickly,
- Drive towards the defenders front foot,
- Distance for skill move (not too far, not too close),
- Opportunity to break down skill moves that work well against a defender in front (scissor, sole roll etc.).
- Disguise using your body (arms, eyes, shoulders) to disguise your move,
- Creativity – try different moves and see what works.
- Accelerate away after player is beaten.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,

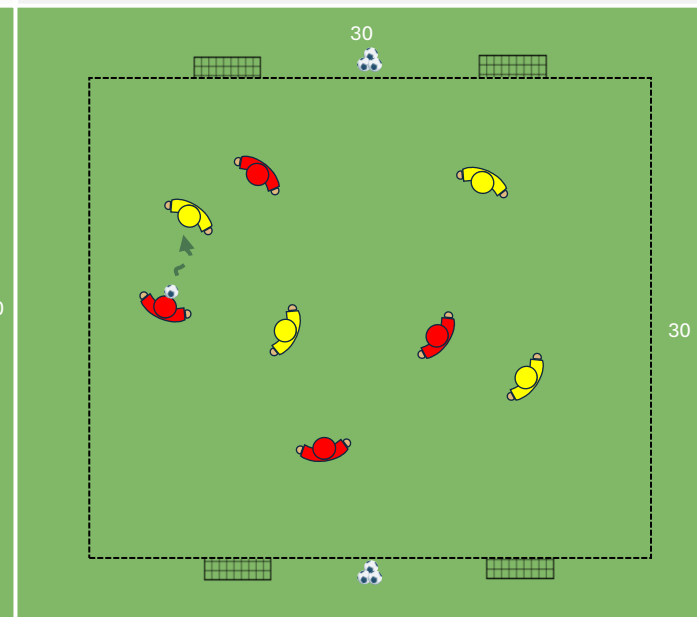
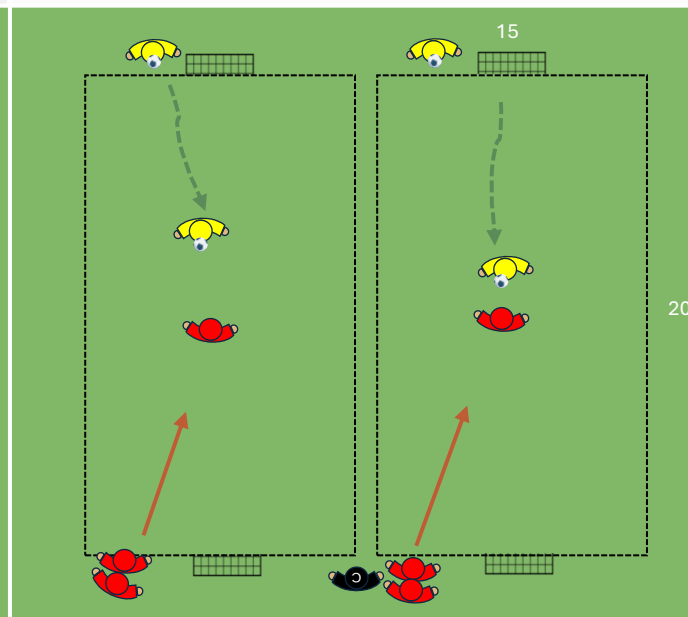
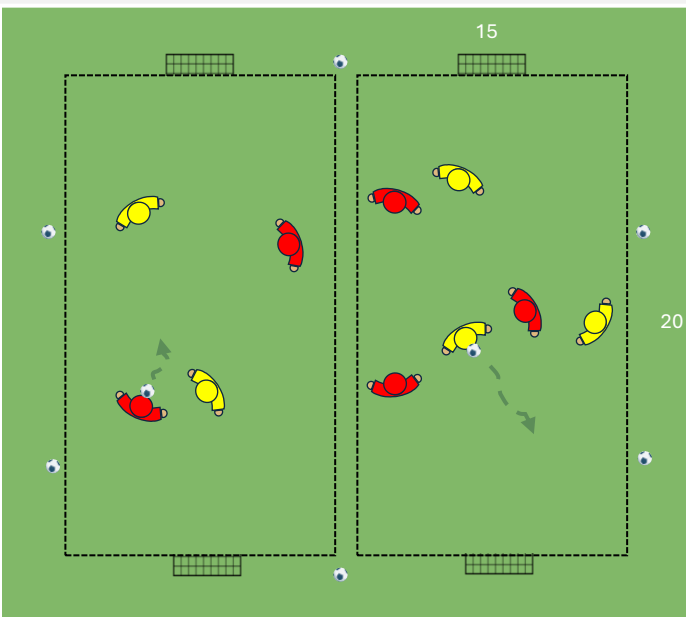
Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can be a player with skill before scoring = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.

Encourage players to drive at each other 1v1. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



Specific Aspect: 1v1 defending to stop forward passes.

Play – Influence

- 2v2+1 small sided games.
- The blue playmaker ('P') plays for the team in possession.
- When ball goes out, ball is to be dribbled back into the area (to encourage more 1v1s).
- Play as a tournament, with each team accumulating points across each game.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today's session is all about winning the ball 1v1 and stopping the opposition passing forward".
- Get there quickly, slow down quickly.
- Surf-board stand to send them one way.
- Force the opposition away from goal.
- Be aware of goal position to protect it.
- Accelerate away after player is beaten.

Practice - Teach

- Resting yellow passes into yellow on field who takes on red defender 1v1.
- Yellow tries to pass into mini goal to score.
- Red looks to win ball and pass to resting yellow.
- Resting red defender rotates in each time.
- Yellow goes off and the resting player comes in to repeat.
- Rotate defenders every 90 seconds.

Possible Progressions:

- When the resting yellow plays in, they join the attack to make a 2v1.

Coaching Points:

- Get there quickly, slow down quickly.
- Surf-board ('Side on body shape') to send the attacker one way.
- Force the opposition away from goal.
- Be aware of goal position to protect it.
- Accelerate away after player is beaten.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,

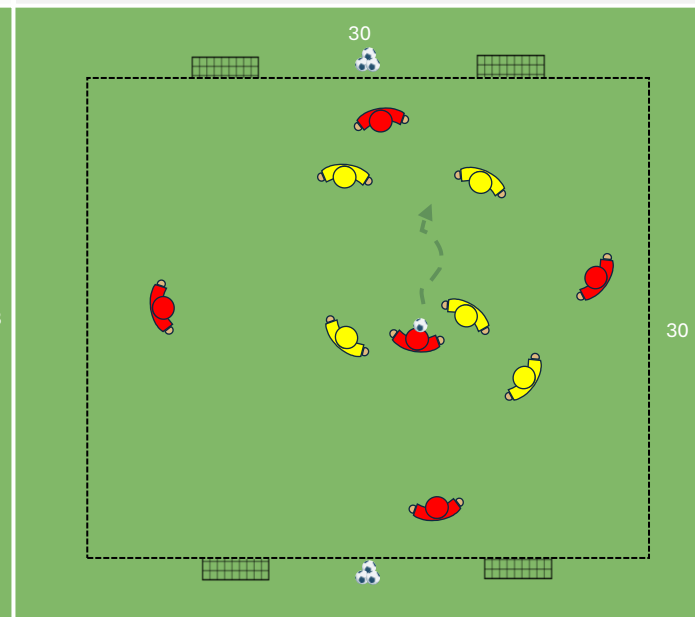
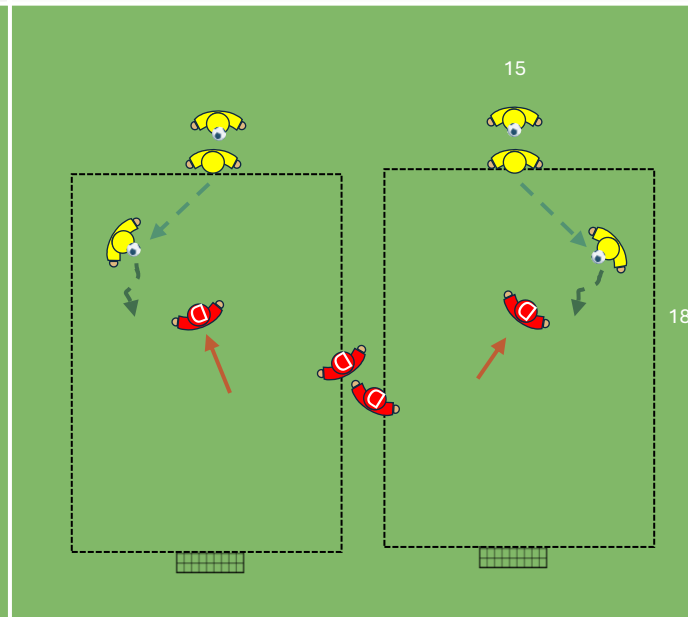
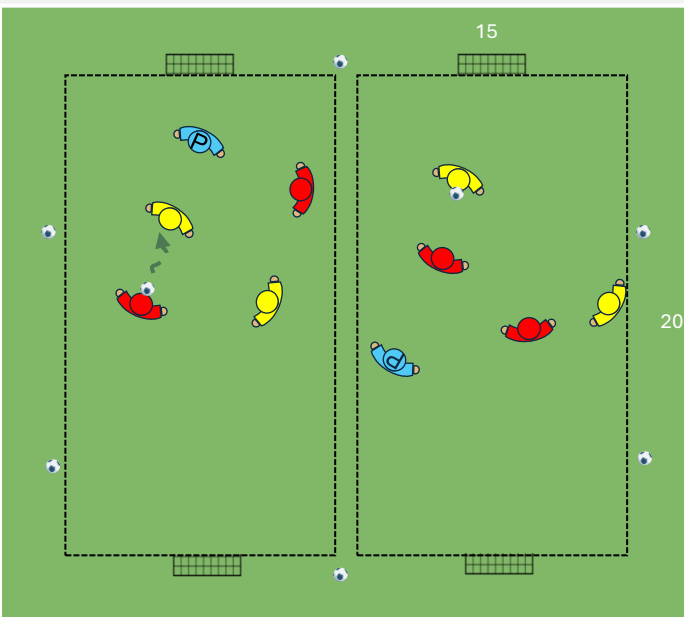
Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can win the ball 1v1 and score in 5 seconds = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.

Encourage players to drive at each other 1v1. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



PASSING



Specific Aspect: Passing forward to break lines.

Play - Influence

- 5v5 3 Zone Game.
- **Reward:** If you can play a pass from the defensive third to attacking third of the field before scoring = 3 goals. (encourages longer, line breaking passes).
- Any other goal is worth 1.

Coaching Points:

- Today's Challenge: "Today we are working on breaking lines, when receiving the ball can you think forward and play the furthest and safest pass you can see?"
- Technique of passing (Lock ankle, inside of foot, pull back and push through).
- Weight of pass (get the ball there quickly but not too hard),
- Body shape to play forward – receive in the direction you wish to go.
- Scanning – Check for Space, Time, Opponents and next pass.

Practice - Teach

- Practice starts unopposed with each team working a ball back and forth between their 'target players'.
- Encourage players to play forward quickly and hit the target as soon as they can.

Possible Progressions:

- When a player passes into a target player, the target drives out and that player replaces them.
- Develop practice to fully opposed possession game – if you play from end to end, your team scores a point. Target player can drive out on receiving or stay static.

Coaching Points:

- Technique of passing (Lock ankle, inside of foot, pull back and push through).
- Weight of pass (get the ball there quickly but not too hard),
- Body shape to play forward – receive in the direction you wish to go.
- Scanning – Check for Space, Time, Opponents and next pass.
- Knowing when to play forward or when to keep.

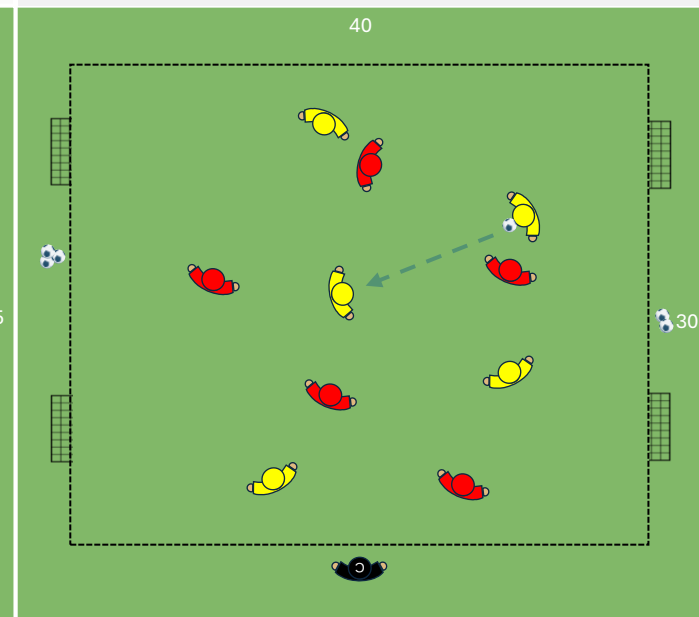
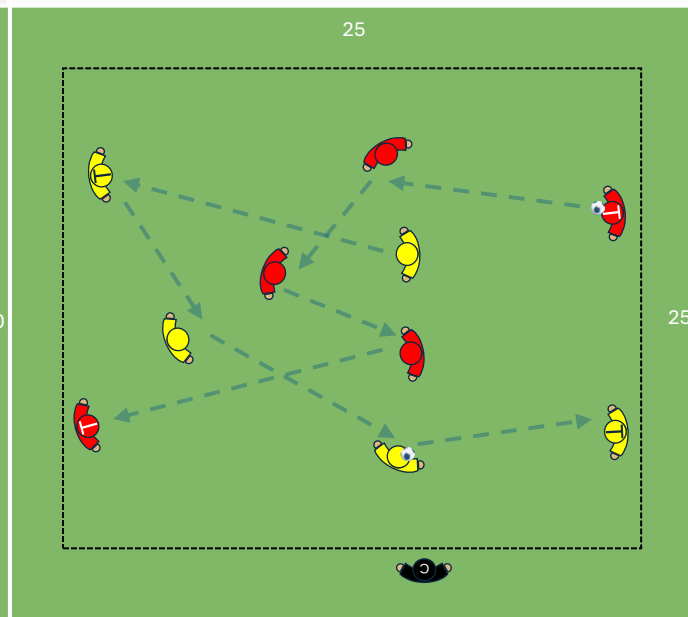
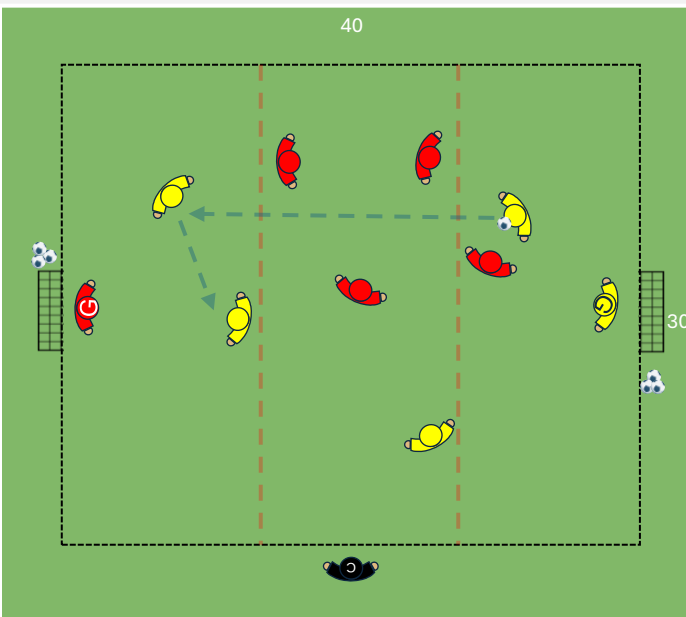
Play - Observe

- 5v5 Small sided 4 goal game.
- If ball goes out, ball is passed back in from the outside line, Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:
- **Reward:** If you can play a pass through two opponents to a team-mate (line breaking pass as shown on diagram) **before** scoring = 3 goals.
- Any other goal is worth 1.

Encourage line breaking passes and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



PASSING



Specific Aspect: Through balls/Killer pass.

Play - Influence

- 5v5 small sided 4 goal end zone game.
- Teams must push forward and leave their end zone empty when defending until the ball goes in.
- To penetrate the end zone the attacking team must play a pass into it for a team-mate to run onto (yellow in example).

Coaching Points:

- Today's Challenge: "Today we are working on killer passes forward!"
- Timing of movement - dribblers forward touch and eyes up are a trigger to start your run.
- Technique & weight of pass (not over-hit or under-hit) to meet a teammates run.
- Scan to see where to play next or where to run.
- Body position open - side on - to receive and play forward.

Practice - Teach

- Practice starts unopposed,
- Both players dribble forward, triggering a forward run from player B.
- Player A plays a through ball for player B to run onto and then score
- Once ball is dead, Player B goes to the back of the closest A queue and Player A follows pass (have resting players behind player B to make rotation quicker).
- Repeat.

Possible Progressions:

- Once player A makes their pass, they defend against the opposite player B (player then follows initial pass when ball is dead).

Coaching Points:

- Timing of movement - dribblers forward touch and eyes up are a trigger to start your run.
- Technique & weight of pass (not over-hit or under-hit) to meet a teammates run.
- Scan to see where to play next or where to run.
- Body position open - side on - to receive and play forward.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game.

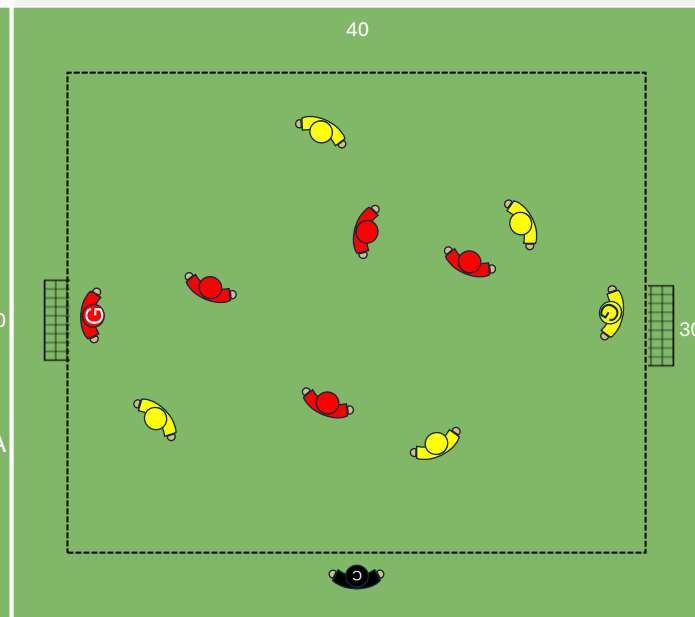
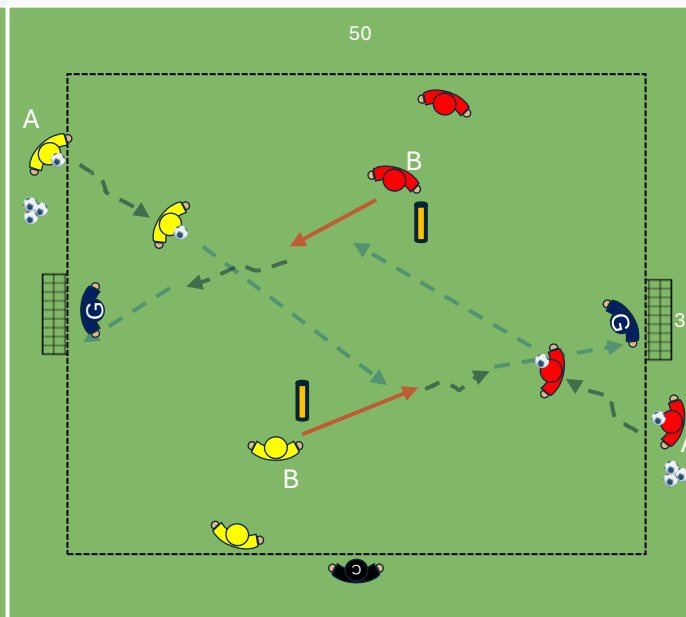
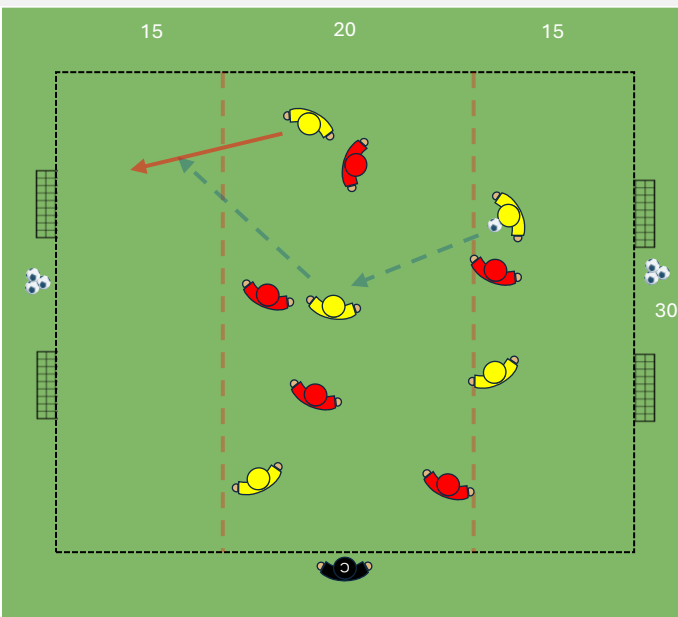
Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can score a goal from a killer pass = 3 goals.
- Any other goal is worth 1.

Encourage killer passes and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



RECEIVING



Specific Aspect: Receiving tightly marked from behind.

Play - Influence

- 3v3 + 2 Playmakers, small sided 4 goal game.
- Each team defends 2 goals.
- Yellows vs Reds, Blues playmakers ('P') play for the team in possession.
- When ball is with blue playmaker, defensive team 'lock on' to each possession player and apply pressure from behind.

Coaching Points:

- Today's Challenge: "Today we are working on receiving away from pressure, try to use smart movement and a great first touch so you can play forward and score".
- Pass to player should be away from the pressure and on an angle.
- Scan over the shoulders – check for space, pressure and options.
- Using arm and body to keep defender away.
- Body position open to play forward.
- Use of deception to create space.
- Speed and direction of touch.

Practice - Teach

- 4 servers on the outside, 3 servers start with footballs.
- Yellow/Reds on the inside work in pairs, one as the receiver, one as the pressure.
- Receiver looks to receive ball with semi pressure from behind, turn and dribble and pass to one of the free players.
- Players then switch roles and repeat.
- Rotate server roles every 90 seconds.

Possible Progressions:

- Increase pressure each round.
- Finish with full 1v1s inside. Players look to play blue from blue to score.

Coaching Points:

- Pass to player should be away from the pressure and on an angle.
- Scan over the shoulders – check for space, pressure and options.
- Using arm and body to keep defender away.
- Body position open to play forward.
- Use of deception to create space.
- Speed and direction of touch.

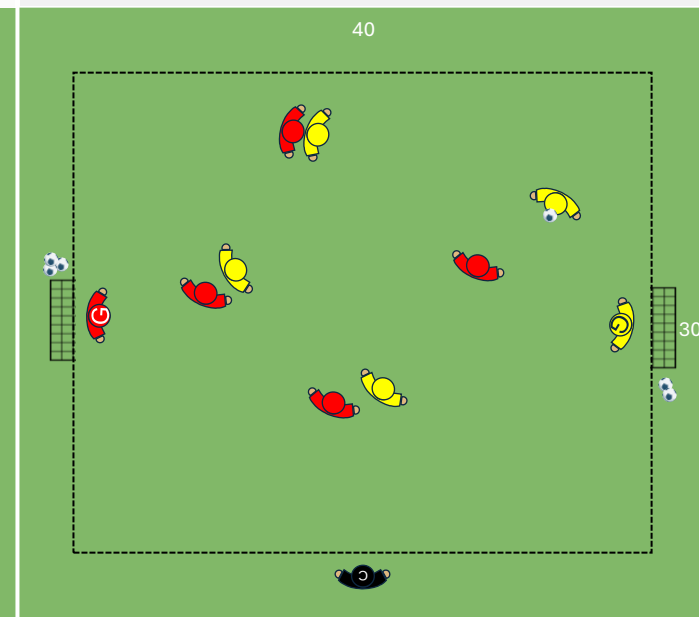
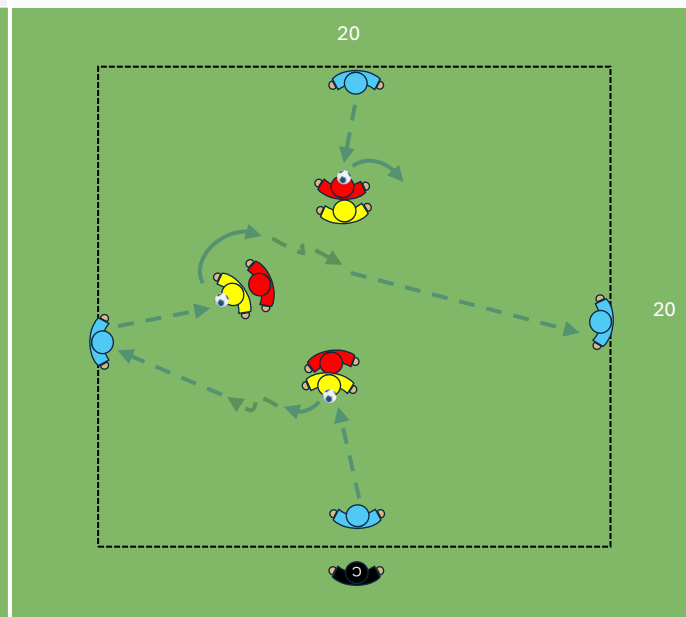
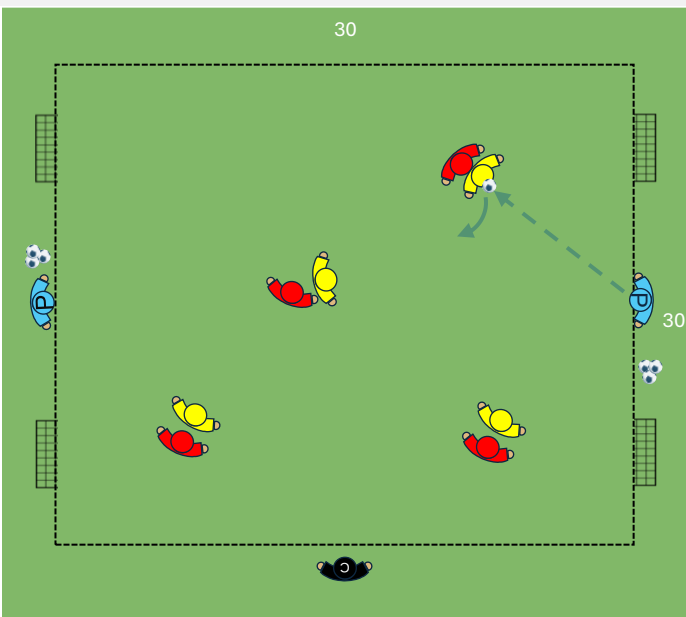
Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,
- When ball is with GK, defending team 'lock on' to a possession team player.

Encourage a creative first touch and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



RECEIVING



Specific Aspect: Receiving with first touch forward/into space.

Play - Influence

- 5v5 Small sided game.
- **Reward:** if you can take your first touch over one of the third lines before scoring = 3 goals.
- Any other goal is worth 1.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today we are working on taking our first touch forward".
- Pass to player should be away from the pressure and on an angle.
- Scan over the shoulders – check for space, pressure and options.
- Body position open to play forward,.
- Speed and direction of touch.
- Support - Can the player on the ball have a player either side to receive?

Practice - Teach

- Each team has a target player on opposite sides as shown.
- Practice starts unopposed, with each team working a ball from target player to target player.

Possible Progressions:

- When you pass into the target player, you take their place, and they drive out.
- Two players must touch ball before it hits the end.
- Develop practice to fully-opposed; to score a point you must pass the ball from your target to the other (can either have the target player static or change every time they receive a pass).

Coaching Points:

- Pass to player should be away from the pressure and on an angle.
- Scan over the shoulders – check for space, pressure and options.
- Body position open to play forward.
- Speed and direction of touch.
- Support - Can the player on the ball have a player either side to receive?

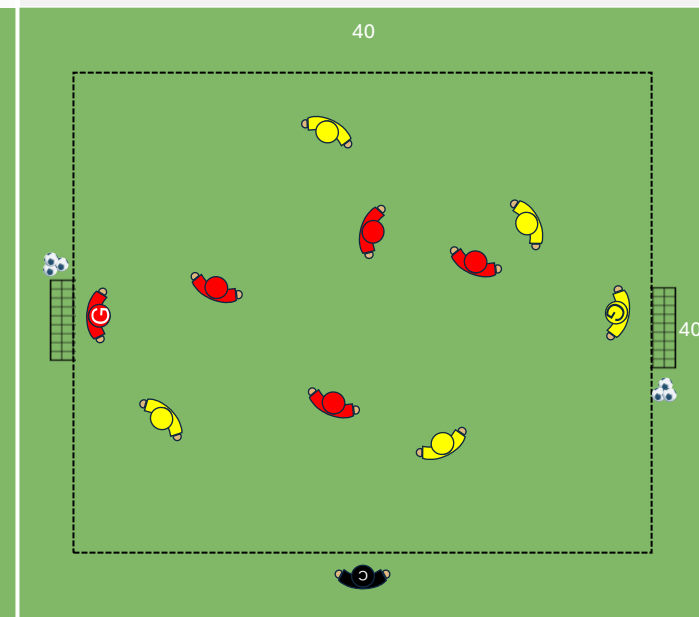
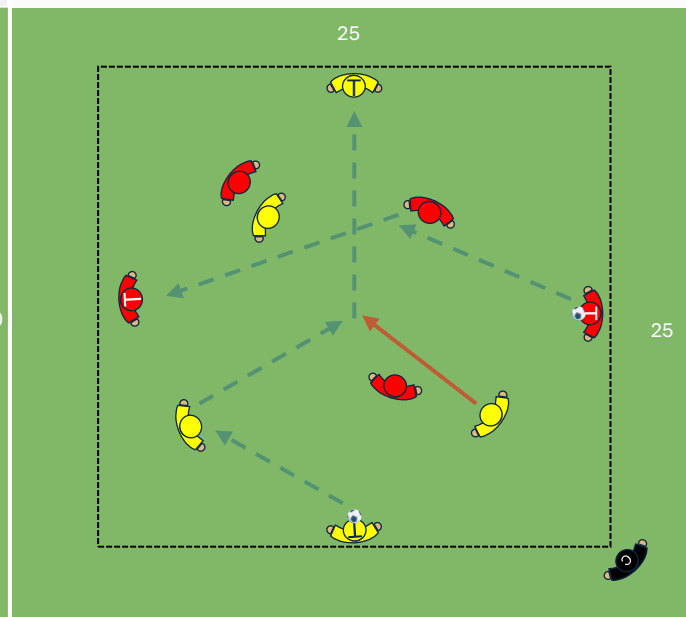
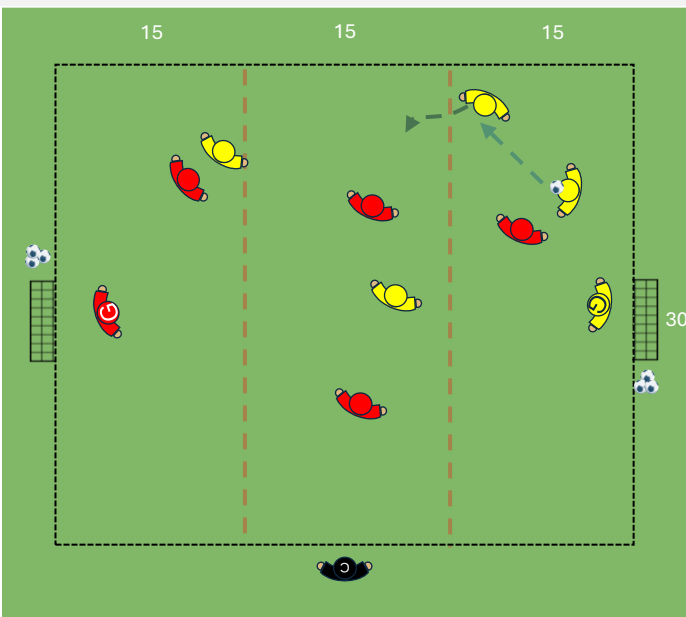
Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,

Encourage a creative first touch and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



FINISHING



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Specific Aspect: Finishing with placement.

Play – Influence

- 4v4 +2 Playmakers small sided game.
- The blue playmaker ('P') plays for the team in possession.
- **Reward:** If you can finish from a cutback from the playmakers = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.
- Encourage wide playmakers to work up and down the line and deliver cutbacks when possible.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today we are working on the placement of our finishing, try your best to finish with placement and to the sides of the goal".
- If your teammate has time and space on the ball, look to use smart movement to receive free.
- When the ball travels to you or after your first touch, try to look up to identify where to shoot.

Practice - Teach

- x2 stations to maximise repetitions (if less players, consolidate to 1).
- Two players act as servers ('S'), other players are finishers.
- Shot 1 – One-Two with server around cone and then finish.
- Shot 2 – Server takes a touch inside and then delivers a cutback for the finisher to shoot.
- Servers rotate with finishers every two minutes.

Possible Progressions:

- All players switch stations to practice other foot.
- Can change shot types.
- Add passive defender who applies pressure from side.

Coaching Points:

- Using short step when approaching the ball.
- Positioning the supporting foot parallel to the shot direction and at the right distance from the ball.
- Locking the ankle – semi-rigid.
- Bending your supporting knee.
- Swinging upwards your opposite arm.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,

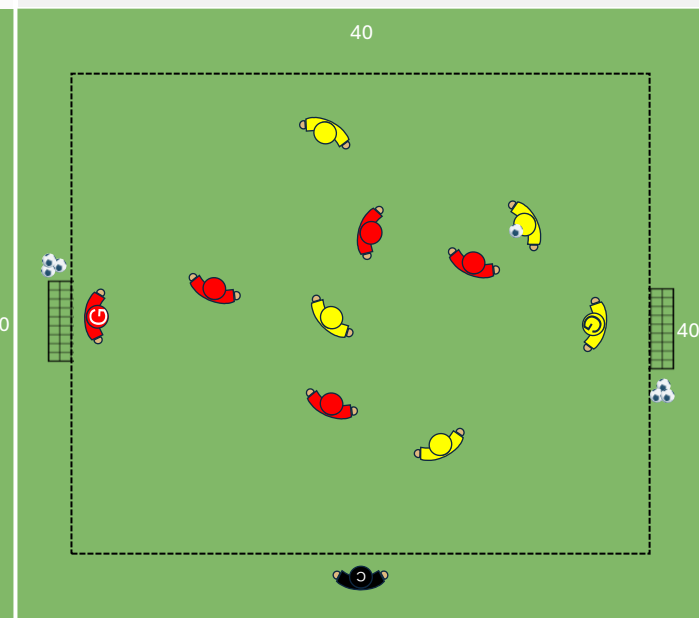
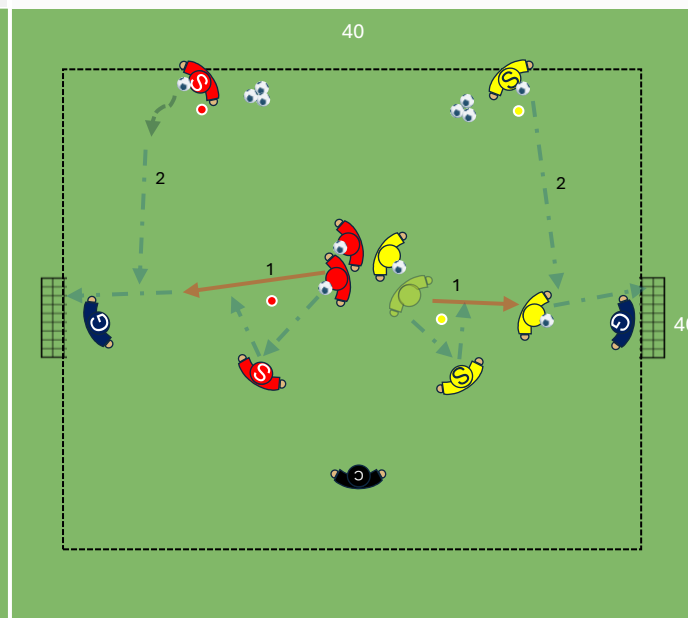
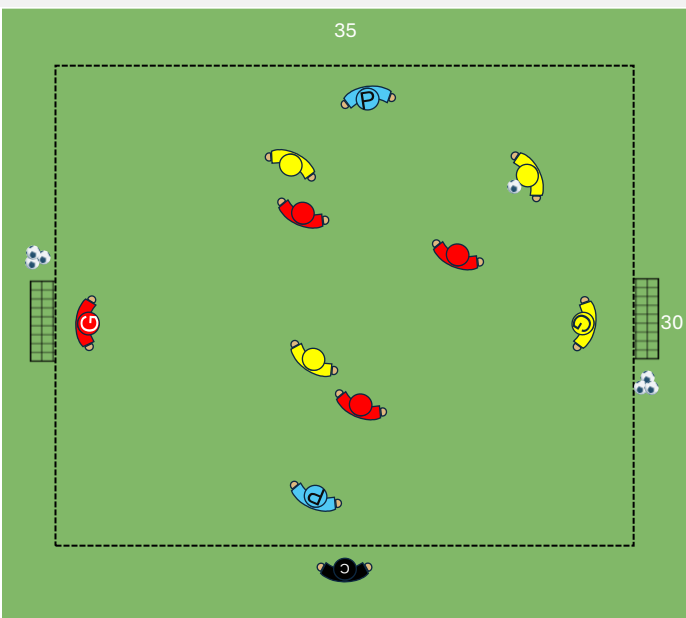
Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can finish from a cutback or first time = 3 goals.
- Every other goal worth a goal.

Encourage finishing and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?



FINISHING



Specific Aspect: Finishing with power.

Play – Influence

- 5v5 Small sided game.
- **Reward:** If you can finish before entering the final third = 3 goals.
- Every other goal is worth 1.
- Encourage early finishing when the player has space.

Coaching Points:

- **Today's Challenge:** "Today we are working on the finishing with power. I want you to work on shooting from distance using your laces!".
- **Body position:** Lean slightly over the ball.
- **Footwork:** Plant your foot beside the ball, about 1–2 feet away, and point it in the direction you want to shoot. Lock your ankle.
- **Impact:** Hit the ball with your instep, or "laces". Strike the ball between the middle and the bottom.
- **Follow through:** Follow through with your foot, leg, and shoulders.

Practice - Teach

- 2v1 Wave Finishing Game,
- Practice starts with two players attacking opposite goal unopposed.
- After attacking, the player who takes the last touch of the ball steps off the pitch and collects ball, the other player defends next attack 2v1.
- Defenders should start with semi pressure, jockeying and looking to keep player on the ball under light pressure when in possession.
- Once turn is over. Players go to the back of the opposite end from start.
- Ask players to try and take turns being the one that shoots.

Possible Progressions:

- Develop practice to fully opposed. Encourage early shots for power.

Coaching Points:

- **Body position:** Lean slightly over the ball.
- **Footwork:** Plant your foot beside the ball, about 1–2 feet away, and point it in the direction you want to shoot. Lock your ankle.
- **Impact:** Hit the ball with your instep, or "laces". Strike the ball between the middle and the bottom.
- **Follow through:** Follow through with your foot, leg, and shoulders.

Play - Observe

- Finish session with a game,

Add a reward to encourage players to engage in the session theme:

- **Reward:** If you can finish with laces or off a rebound = 3 goals.
- Every other goal worth a goals.

Encourage finishing and effort. Allow the players to play!

Coach Self Reflection:

- Did the players get the opportunity to practice their technique?
- Did you find the opportunity to develop the individual player within the session?
- Did you see a change in the players behaviour relating to the specific aspect (if not, what could you do differently?).
- Did you create a safe and enjoyable environment?

